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Luke 8:11–15

In Luke 8:11–15, we learn that when we hear God’s Word with a loving heart and persevere in our faith, we are like a seed that grows in rich soil.

Directions: Locate Luke 8:11–15 in the Bible and read it silently. Think about what it means to “bear fruit through perseverance.” Perseverance means staying with something even through difficulty. Think of the heart as a seed. From the heart, draw the roots, the stem, some leaves, and a fruit growing from a branch of your plant. In the space around, write what you think the fruit is—that is, what you do to serve God the Father through his Son, Jesus.

P
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R
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V
E
R
A
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C
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My Own Parables

We can think of our own parables to describe God's kingdom.

Directions: Write ideas for your own parables by finishing the sentences below. The first one is completed as an example. Choose one sentence you finished. On the lines below the sentences, write it as a complete parable with more explanation.



1. The Kingdom of God is like a garden, because everything is peaceful there.
2. The Kingdom of God is like _____, because everyone is gathered together.
3. The Kingdom of God is like a sunny day, because _____.
4. The Kingdom of God is like a special gift, because _____.
5. The Kingdom of God is like _____, because _____.





Luke 8:11–15

Reader: A reading from the holy Gospel according to Luke.

All: Glory to you, Lord.
(*The Reader reads aloud the passage.*)

Reader: The Gospel of the Lord.

All: Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

Leader: Jesus, our loving teacher, thank you for using parables to help us understand your Word.

All: Help us be like rich soil so that everything you teach us helps us grow and thrive.

Leader: Help us be steady in our faith and remember you are with us in good times and hard times.

All: Help us remember that all good things in life are gifts from God our Father. Lord, we give you thanks.



Reflecting on the Scripture Passage

Draw plants and fruits in the part of the rectangle where the Word of God lives and grows.

Path	Thorns
Rocky Ground	Rich Soil

Session 6 Assessment

A. Circle *T* if the statement is true or *F* if it is false.

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Saint Scholastica and Saint Benedict did not know each other. | T | F |
| 2. When Scholastica and Benedict grew up, they started religious communities. | T | F |
| 3. Jesus told parables to show what the Kingdom of God is like. | T | F |
| 4. Jesus said that the Kingdom of God is far away. | T | F |
| 5. One of Jesus' parables shows how the kingdom exists within the smallest of things. | T | F |
| 6. A community of monks lives in a monastery. | T | F |
| 7. Scholastica and Benedict met together once a year to pray. | T | F |
| 8. A parable is a rhyming poem. | T | F |
| 9. Jesus teaches us that only big acts of kindness can make a difference. | T | F |
| 10. Jesus loved only certain people. | T | F |
| 11. We can serve God's kingdom in our daily lives. | T | F |
| 12. A convent is a type of religious community. | T | F |
| 13. The name Benedict means "blessed." | T | F |
| 14. We can follow Jesus by loving one another and living according to God's rule and direction. | T | F |

Name _____ Date _____

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ASSESSMENT**



SESSION 6

Session 6 Assessment

B. Draw a picture that shows one of Jesus' parables. Then write one or two sentences that explain your picture.

C. What are two small acts of kindness you can do regularly to serve God's kingdom?



Mark 8:34–36

In Mark 8:34–36, Jesus tells us the responsibilities we take on in following him.

Directions: Locate Mark 8:34–36 in the Bible and read it silently. Crack the code and use it to solve the puzzle. The answer is a summary of the passage.



A	E	I	O	U	D	F	G	H
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
J	L	M	N	R	S	T	V	W
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18

10	2	15	5	15	3	13	17	3	16	2	15
5	15	16	4								
7	4	11	11	4	18	9	3	12			
16	4	8	4	6							
16	9	2	7	1	16	9	2	14			



Before and After

Conversion means the change that occurs when we turn to God.

Directions: Part of the chart is filled in below. Complete the chart by filling in the Before and After parts accordingly.

Before Conversion	After Conversion
I did whatever I wanted.	
	I give part of the money I earn to help other people and the community.
I argued with my parents.	
	I am grateful to God for food that is placed before me.
I was sure I could take care of myself.	
	I think of Mass as a wonderful gift from God.



Mark 8:34–36

Reader: A reading from the holy Gospel according to Mark.

All: Glory to you, Lord.
(The Reader reads aloud the passage.)

Reader: The Gospel of the Lord.

All: Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

Leader: Jesus, you show us the way to God the Father.

All: We praise you, Lord!

Leader: Jesus, we are your disciples, and we accept your invitation to follow you to the Father.

All: We follow you, Lord!

Leader: We will live our lives for your glory and make good choices, even when it is hard.

All: We live for you, Lord!

Leader: Jesus, we thank you for giving your life for our salvation. We promise to keep your sacrifice in our hearts and remember what is important.

All: We thank you, Lord!

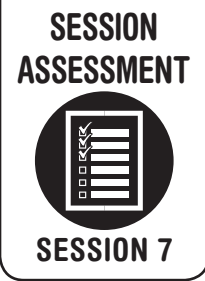


Session 7 Assessment

A. Circle the letter of the choice that best completes each sentence.

1. The rich man asked Jesus what he must do to
 - a. be happy.
 - b. make more money.
 - c. be a good leader.
 - d. gain eternal life.
2. Jesus asked the rich man to give up
 - a. reading the Bible.
 - b. his teachers.
 - c. what he owned.
 - d. all his friends.
3. God wants us to love him
 - a. only on Sundays.
 - b. just a little.
 - c. and then turn away.
 - d. above all else.
4. Turning away from sin and back to God is called
 - a. conversion.
 - b. commandment.
 - c. wealth.
 - d. charity.
5. We live peacefully with one another when we follow the Ten
 - a. Offerings.
 - b. Rules of Peace.
 - c. Commandments.
 - d. Disciples.
6. We make choices about how to act toward God and others
 - a. only once a year.
 - b. every day.
 - c. only during Mass.
 - d. only on Sundays.
7. As we offer the Sign of Peace at Mass, we share the
 - a. Ten Commandments.
 - b. Apostles' Creed.
 - c. peace of Christ.
 - d. Lord's Prayer.
8. Jesus wants us to follow the Ten Commandments, but he also asks us to
 - a. do less.
 - b. do more.
 - c. make friends.
 - d. walk quietly.

Name _____ Date _____



Session 7 Assessment

B. Draw a picture that shows you following one of the Ten Commandments. Then write a sentence that explains your picture.

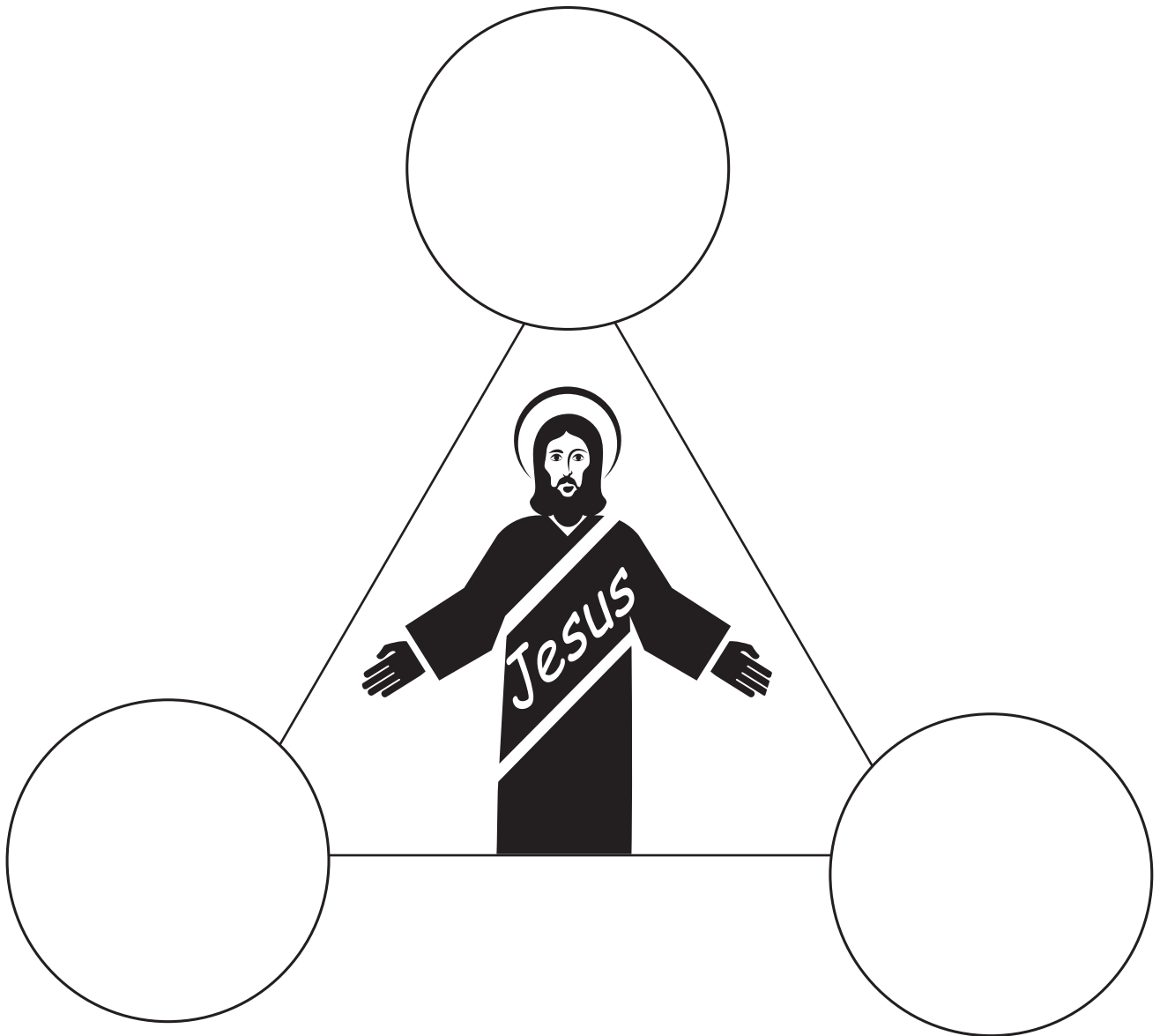
C. What is one way that you can use what you have to serve God's kingdom?



John 1:35–39

In John 1:35–39, we learn that when the disciples met Jesus, they knew that he is God's Son.

Directions: Locate John 1:35–39 in the Bible and read it silently. Find names the disciples called Jesus in the passage, including the meaning of one of the names. Write those names in the circles around Jesus.



Name _____ Date _____

ACTIVITY

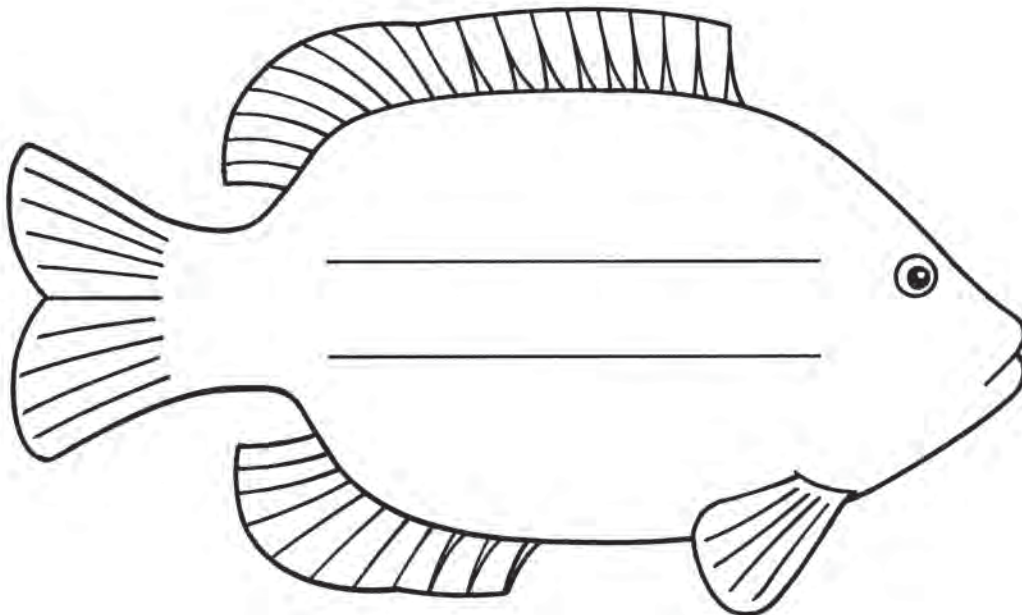
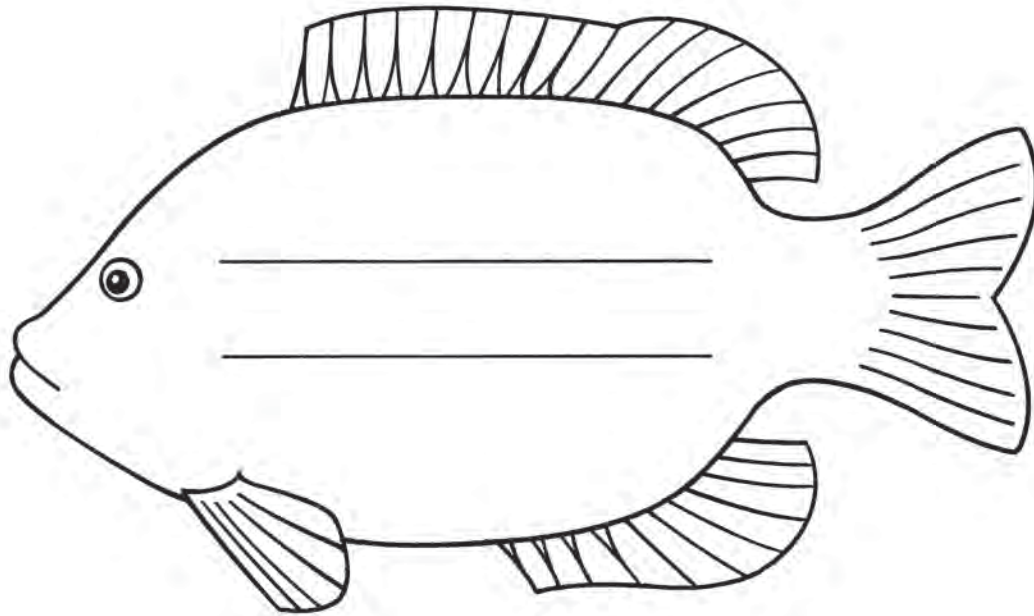


SESSION 8

Fishing for Good Deeds

Jesus called his disciples "fishers of men."

Directions: On each fish below, write a good deed that you could do to show God's love to others. Then decorate the fish and cut them out. Place the fish in a basket. Each day someone can pull a fish from the basket to give everyone in the group a good deed to do.





John 1:35–39

Reader: A reading from the holy Gospel according to John.

All: Glory to you, Lord.
(The Reader reads aloud the passage.)

Reader: The Gospel of the Lord.

All: Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

Leader: God the Father promised to come to us as the Messiah.

All: God, you fulfilled your promise when you came to us as your Son, Jesus, our Lord and Savior.

Leader: When the disciples saw you as your Son, Jesus, they called you “Rabbi,” “Teacher.” They wanted to be close to you and learn from you.

All: Heavenly Father, help us learn to live as disciples of Jesus, your Son.

Leader: God our Father, Jesus, your Son, gathered the disciples to help share your message of love and salvation.

All: Heavenly Father, help us share the Good News of your Son, Jesus.



Session 8 Assessment

A. Write the word from the word box that best completes each sentence.

Apostles	pope	see	twelve	disciples
proclaim	people	fisherman	Gospels	mission

1. The Good News of Jesus' life is told in the _____.
2. Jesus welcomed the disciples, saying, "Come and you will _____."
3. Peter was a _____.
4. Jesus told Peter that from now on, Peter would be catching _____ instead of fish.
5. Peter was one of Jesus' _____.
6. Jesus chose _____ Apostles to spread his message.
7. Jesus' _____ was to proclaim the Kingdom of God.
8. The Apostles' mission today is continued by the _____ and bishops of the Catholic Church.
9. Besides choosing Apostles, Jesus chose _____ to help him gather followers.
10. Jesus wanted his disciples to _____ the Kingdom of God.

Name _____ Date _____

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SESSION 8

Session 8 Assessment

B. Draw a picture that shows a time you and your friends worked together to get something done. Then write a sentence that explains your picture.

C. Peter and the other disciples showed that they trusted Jesus. Why would this have been difficult? How were they rewarded?

Name _____ Date _____

SACRED
SCRIPTURE



SESSION 9

Luke 24:1–12

In Luke 24:1–12, we read what the women who had been following Jesus found when they came to his tomb.

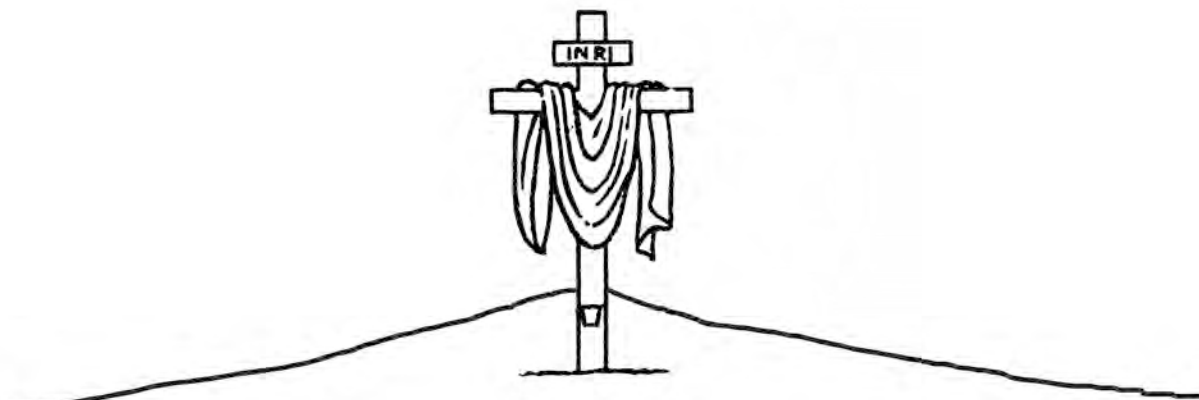
Directions: Locate Luke 24:1–12 in the Bible and read it silently.
Draw a comic strip to show what happened in the passage.



Paschal Mystery

Directions: Fill in the blanks with words about the Paschal Mystery. Then unscramble the letters in the circles to form a new word.

1. Jesus Christ sends the Holy _____ _____
to share in his life.
2. Jesus Christ _____ _____ from the dead and appeared
to _____ and the Apostles.
3. Jesus opened the gates of _____ _____.
4. Jesus' passage from Death to Resurrection is the Paschal
 _____.
5. Because Jesus _____ _____ is God,
we call him _____.
6. We receive _____ _____ to be faithful to God.





Luke 24:1–12

Reader: A reading from the holy Gospel according to Luke.

All: Glory to you, Lord.
(The Reader reads aloud the passage.)

Reader: The Gospel of the Lord.

All: Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

Leader: What surprise and joy the women must have felt when they learned that our Lord and Savior had risen from the dead on the third day after his Death!

All: Alleluia, Christ is risen!

Leader: Through his Death, Resurrection, and Ascension, Jesus has given us new life in him.

All: Alleluia, Christ is risen!

Leader: We rejoice in Jesus' precious gift of salvation from our sins. Through him, we have eternal life.

All: Alleluia, Christ is risen!





Session 9 Assessment

A. Circle the choice that best completes each sentence.

1. Saint (Paul Joseph) wrote a letter to his friends in Corinth.
2. Jesus' passage from death to Resurrection to Ascension is called the (Paschal Holy) Mystery.
3. Because Jesus Christ is the Son of God, we call him (Lord Chief Apostle).
4. Jesus Christ shares his life with us by sending us (a letter the Holy Spirit).
5. A symbol of Jesus' Resurrection is the (rainbow butterfly).
6. After rising from the dead, Jesus appeared to Peter and the (Apostles shepherds).
7. Jesus suffered under (the pharaoh Pontius Pilate).
8. Jesus rose from the dead on the (first third) day.
9. Paul wanted the people of Corinth to believe and be (saved amazed).
10. Jesus said, "I am the (resurrection crucifixion) and the life."
11. After Jesus rose again from the dead, he (ascended descended) into heaven.
12. Jesus Christ (lived died) for our sins.
13. Through Jesus' Death and Resurrection, we are (alone saved).
14. The Apostles' (Creed Psalm) is our faith prayer.
15. After Jesus died, he opened the gates of (heaven Eden) for the just people who had died before him.

Name _____ Date _____

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SESSION 9

Session 9 Assessment

B. Draw a picture of the risen Jesus. Then write a sentence that explains your picture.

C. How do you think the Apostles felt when Jesus appeared before them after his Resurrection? Why would this event strengthen their faith?



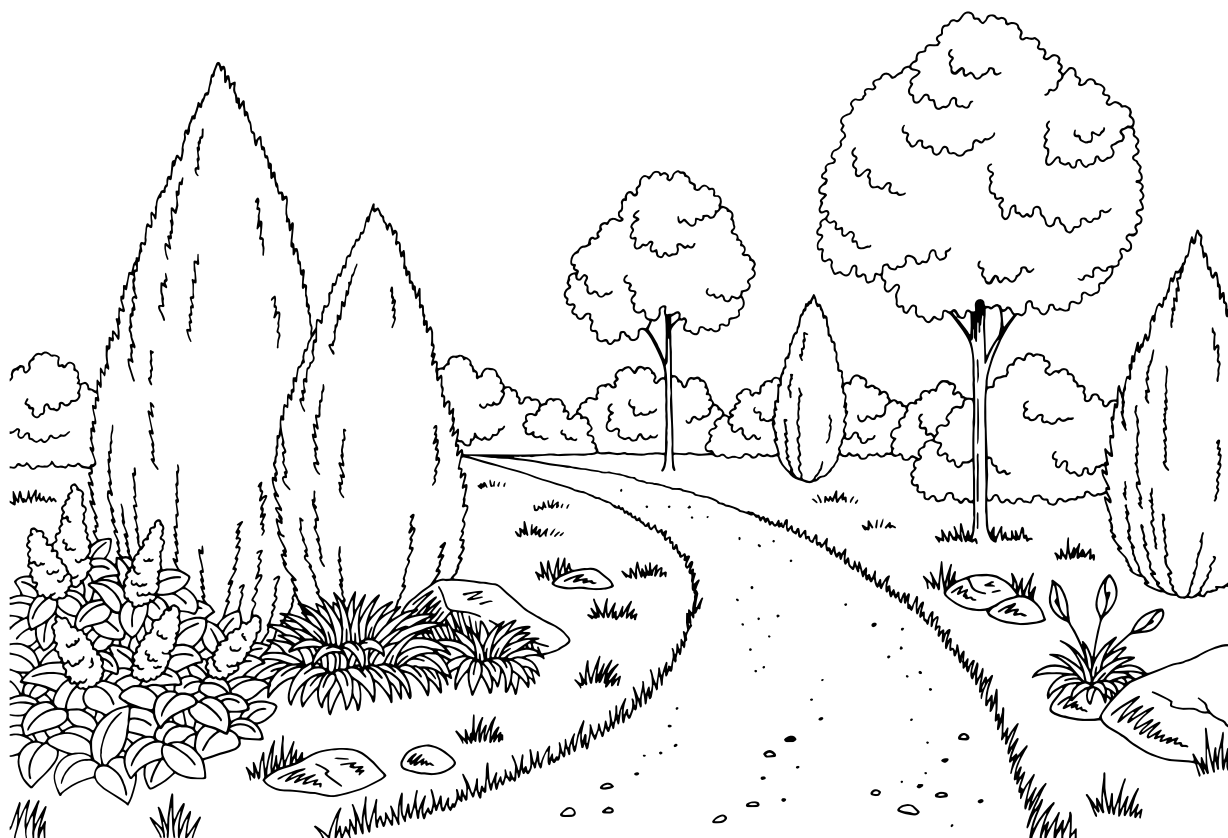
Isaiah 40:3–5

In Isaiah 40:3–5, we read Isaiah’s prophecy of the coming of the Messiah, God with us. Isaiah tells us that God has said to prepare the way.

Directions: Locate Isaiah 40:3–5 in the Bible and read it silently. Write what the voice told Isaiah the people should do. Then write what you will do to prepare the way for the Lord.

What was Isaiah told to do?

What will you do to prepare for the coming of Jesus, the Son of God?



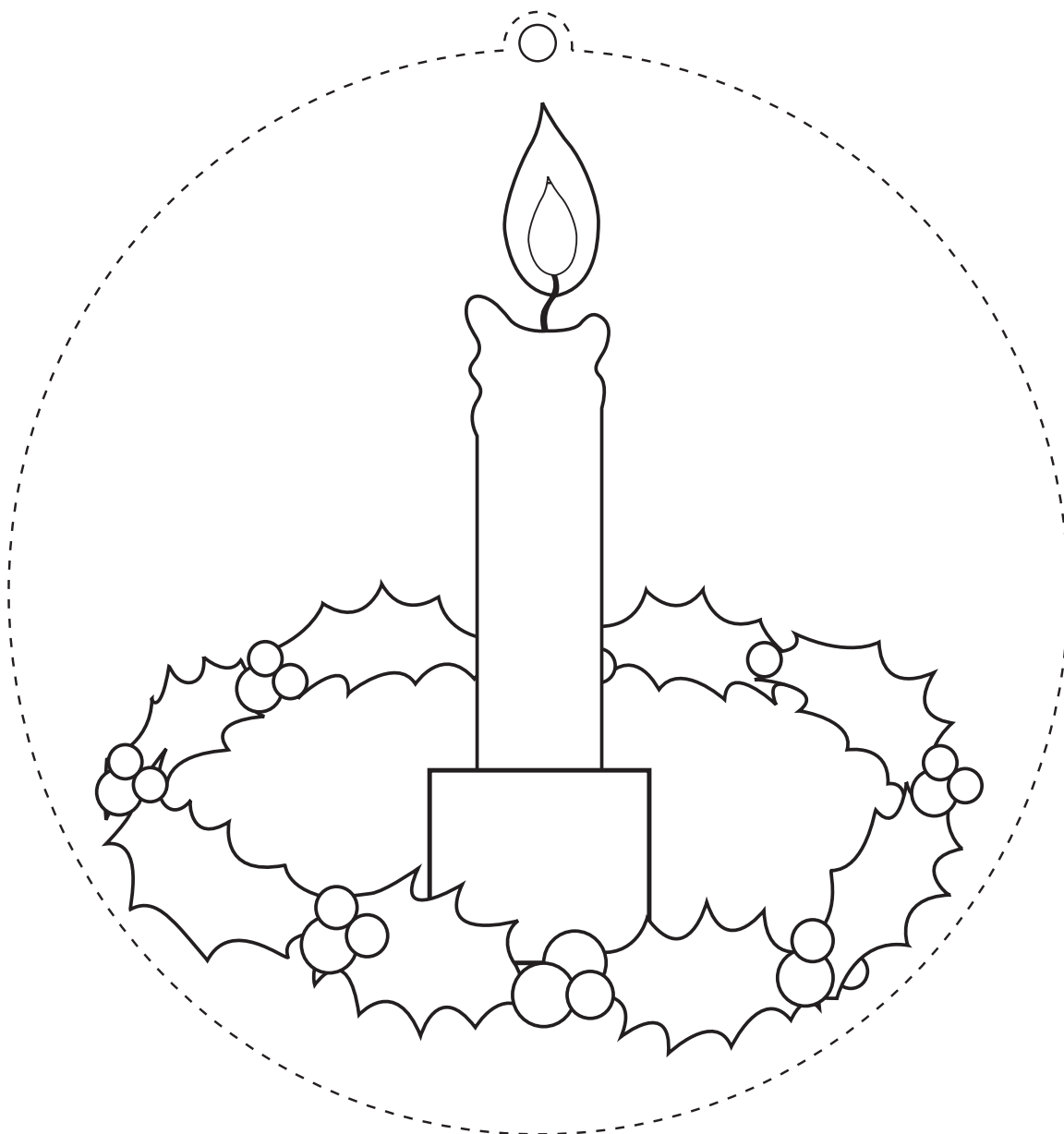


We Prepare for Jesus

Advent is the season to prepare our homes and our hearts to celebrate Jesus' birth.

Directions: Make an Advent candle for your family.

1. Decorate the candle using crayons or markers.
2. Cut out the circle around the candle along the dotted line.
3. On the back, write a prayer that you and your family can pray together this Advent.
4. Punch a hole in the top and thread string through the hole.
5. Hang your candle where you and your family can see it.





Isaiah 40:3–5

Reader: A reading from the Book of the prophet Isaiah.
(*The Reader reads aloud the passage.*)
The Word of the Lord.

All: Thanks be to God.

Leader: Prepare the way of the Lord!

All: We prepare the way for you, Lord.

Leader: Heavenly Father, you promise to lift every valley.

All: You promise to make smooth roads through
rough places.

Leader: Heavenly Father, open our eyes so that we may
see your glory.

All: We look forward to your coming again.

Leader: Heavenly Father, open our ears so that we may
hear your holy Word.

All: Lord, bless us with your grace.

Leader: Heavenly Father, open our hearts so that we may
experience your everlasting love for us.

All: Lord, bless us with your grace.



Session 10 Assessment

A. Circle the letter of the choice that best completes each sentence.

1. We celebrate Advent after we celebrate
 - a. Christmas.
 - b. Mass.
 - c. Ordinary Time.
 - d. New Year's Day.
2. Advent begins _____ Sundays before December 25.
 - a. two
 - b. three
 - c. four
 - d. five
3. Advent ends at
 - a. Thanksgiving.
 - b. noon.
 - c. Easter.
 - d. Christmas Mass.
4. You can prepare your home for Advent by displaying
 - a. an Advent wreath.
 - b. an Advent calendar.
 - c. both a and b.
 - d. none of these.
5. Advent is a time to prepare _____ to celebrate the birth of Jesus.
 - a. our winter clothes
 - b. songs and poems
 - c. our parents and our pets
 - d. our hearts and our homes
6. Advent candles remind us that Jesus is
 - a. always nearby.
 - b. the Light of the World.
 - c. wrapped in swaddling clothes.
 - d. warming our hearts.
7. Advent is represented by the color
 - a. purple.
 - b. blue.
 - c. green.
 - d. white.
8. The word *Advent* comes from a Latin word that means
 - a. "coming" or "arrival."
 - b. "begin" or "launch."
 - c. "adventure."
 - d. "wind" or "whisper."

Name _____ Date _____

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SESSION 10

Session 10 Assessment

B. Draw a picture that shows how your family celebrates Advent. Then write a sentence that explains your picture.

C. How does your family prepare to celebrate a holiday such as Thanksgiving or Independence Day? How are these preparations similar to and different from the ways we prepare to celebrate the birth of Jesus?



Unit 2 Assessment

A. Circle the letter of the choice that best completes each sentence.

1. Jesus told Peter that instead of fish, he would soon be catching
 - a. butterflies.
 - b. mustard seeds.
 - c. wild animals.
 - d. people.
2. The story of the mustard seed is an example of
 - a. a psalm.
 - b. a parable.
 - c. a commandment.
 - d. a disciple.
3. The parable of the yeast teaches us that a little bit can
 - a. make a big difference.
 - b. make the sun rise.
 - c. make good bread.
 - d. make no difference.
4. We show love for God and others by following
 - a. the shortest path.
 - b. whatever we choose.
 - c. the directions for a game.
 - d. the Ten Commandments.
5. Jesus said that everyone who lives and believes in him will never
 - a. die.
 - b. be happy.
 - c. be wealthy.
 - d. fish.
6. The color of the altar cloth and priest's vestments during Advent is
 - a. green.
 - b. white
 - c. purple.
 - d. gold.
7. The season of Advent is a time of
 - a. remembrance.
 - b. preparation.
 - c. celebration.
 - d. all of the above.
8. Turning away from sin and back to God is called
 - a. conversion.
 - b. charity.
 - c. a commandment.
 - d. resurrection.



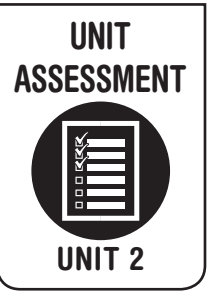
Unit 2 Assessment

B. Write the word that best completes each sentence.

mission	monastery	religious	Paschal
Kingdom	apostle	Gospels	grace
faithful	butterfly		

9. Mary and Joseph were _____ to God's plan.
10. The books of the Bible that tell the Good News of Jesus' life are the _____.
11. Saint Scholastica and Saint Benedict started _____ communities.
12. A community of monks lives in a _____.
13. Jesus' apostles and disciples accepted the _____ of proclaiming God's kingdom.
14. An _____ is a person who is sent forth, entrusted with a mission by Jesus.
15. The _____ of God calls us to love one another and live according to God's rule and direction.
16. Jesus' passage from Death to Resurrection to Ascension is called the _____ Mystery.
17. The _____ is a symbol of Jesus' Resurrection.
18. The Holy Spirit gives us the _____ through which we turn back to God.

Name _____ Date _____



Unit 2 Assessment

Show What You Know

C. Recall the messages of Jesus' parables of the yeast and of the mustard seed. Choose one of them. Write what you do in your life to reflect the message of that parable.

Beliefs and Perceptions

D. We are instructed to love one another as much as we love ourselves and to love God above all else. How does God help us do this? Why is this sometimes difficult for people to do?
